
9. Donate something other than money

Gift cards, frequent flyer miles, food from your cupboard, even your newspaper subscription while you're on vacation—you might have more untapped value sitting around than you realize. If you're thinking about donating a car, make sure you thoroughly investigate the organization first.

10. The pickle jar

Maybe you've been lucky enough to get forwarded that chestnut of a dad

who saves his quarters in a pickle jar for his son's college education. When I was growing up, my dad saved his quarters for Vegas. At any rate, the same strategy can be used to gather an annual donation. When you're cleaning out the pickle jar, don't forget to also look for coins in your couch cushions, laundry area, car, pockets, etc.

Knowing that you're helping someone live a much better life makes all that scrounging seem worthwhile, no? — **Carrie Kirby**

